

Grace C. Kim

EECS/CSAIL PhD student at MIT ([HCI](#) + [ML](#))

My research focuses on improving the interpretability and trustworthiness of ML models. I develop [interactive visualization tools](#) for visually analyzing model decision-making, and [interpretability methods](#) for understanding and controlling model behavior.

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🏠 gracekimcy.github.io

🎓 [Google Scholar](#)
📄 [CV PDF](#)

Education

Sep. 2026 —	Ph.D. in Electrical Engineering & Computer Science Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge, MA Advisor: Mitchell Gordon 🏆 NSF Graduate Research Fellowship
Aug. 2025 — May 2026	M.S. in Computer Science Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA Advisor: Duen Horng (Polo) Chau , Co-advisor: Mark Riedl Concentration in Machine Learning, GPA: 4.00/4.00 🏆 Stamps President's Scholarship
Aug. 2022 — May 2025	B.S. in Computer Science Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA Thesis: <i>Transformer Explainer: Interactive Visual Learning of LLM Transformers</i> Advisor: Duen Horng (Polo) Chau , Co-advisor: Betsy DiSalvo (Mentor: Annabel Rothschild) Concentrations in Artificial Intelligence and Theory, GPA: 3.9/4.0, Highest Honors 🏆 Stamps President's Scholarship
Summer 2023	Berlin Summer Program Technische Universität Berlin, Germany Study abroad program by Georgia Tech College of Computing

Research Experience

Sep. 2026 — Present	Massachusetts Institute of Technology , Cambridge, MA <i>Research Assistant, Interactive Alignment Lab</i> Advisor: Mitchell Gordon Study AI alignment and safety.
Jan. 2024 — May 2026	Georgia Institute of Technology , Atlanta, GA <i>Research Assistant, Polo Club of Data Science</i> Advisor: Duen Horng (Polo) Chau Study the intersection of machine learning, human-computer interaction, and data visualization.
May 2025 — May 2026	Georgia Institute of Technology , Atlanta, GA <i>Research Assistant, Entertainment Intelligence and Human-Centered AI Labs</i> Advisor: Mark Riedl Study explainable AI and mechanistic interpretability.
May 2024 — Aug. 2024	CISPA Helmholtz Center for Information Security , Saarbrücken, Germany <i>DAAD RISE Research Intern, SprintML Lab</i> Advisor: Adam Dziedzic, Franziska Boenisch Studied memorization in CLIP models.
Aug. 2023 — Oct. 2024	Georgia Institute of Technology , Atlanta, GA <i>Research Assistant, Culture and Technology Lab</i> Advisor: Betsy DiSalvo , Mentor: Annabel Rothschild Studied critical data studies and responsible AI.

Honors and Awards

2026	Donald V. Jackson Fellowship, Georgia Tech College of Computing
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	Awarded to well-rounded, first-year Master's student who embodies values of academic excellence and leadership
2026	Fulbright Scholarship (Research Award), US Department of State (awarded; declined to accept NSF GRFP) Selected as one of 8 awardees for the US-Korea Presidential STEM Initiative Award
2026 — 2031	Graduate Research Fellowship (GRFP), NSF 5-year fellowship providing 3 years of financial support for independent research
2026	Vamasundari Devi Fellowship, MIT EECS 1-semester fellowship providing full financial support
2025	Best Submission, Workshop on Visualization for AI Explainability at IEEE VIS For "Transformer Explainer: Learning LLM Transformers with Interactive Visual Explanation and Experimentation"
2025	President's Undergraduate Research Travel Award, Georgia Tech For "Transformer Explainer: Interactive Learning of Text-Generative Models"
2024	DAAD RISE Scholarship, German Federal Foreign Office Selected as one of 320 awardees from 2,358 applicants to conduct a summer research internship in Germany
2024	REU Scholarship, NSF (awarded; declined to accept DAAD RISE) Selected to participate in NSF research experience for undergraduates (REU)
2024	Best Poster, IEEE VIS For "Transformer Explainer: Interactive Learning of Text-Generative Models"
2024	President's Undergraduate Research Travel Award, Georgia Tech For "What's Your Stake in Sustainability of AI?: An Informed Insider's Guide"
2022 — 2026	Stamps President's Scholarship, Georgia Tech 4-year full-ride merit scholarship with \$15,000 in extracurricular funding awarded to the top 0.1% of applicants (40 students) to Georgia Tech

Publications

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Transformer Explainer: Learning LLM Transformers with Interactive Visual Explanation and Experimentation

Aeree Cho, Grace C. Kim, Alexander Karpekov, Seongmin Lee, Alec Helbling, Benjamin Hoover, Zijie J. Wang, Minsuk Kahng, Duen Horng Chau

ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems. 2026. (CHI). 2026.

PDF

Recording

BibTeX

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Counterfactual Explanations for Agentic Workflows

Madhuri Singh*, Grace C. Kim*, Mika Okamoto*, Aarushi Ammavajjala, Amal Alabdulkarim, Gennie Mansi, Mark O. Riedl

Human-Centered Explainable AI Workshop at CHI 2026 (HCXAI). 2026.

PDF

BibTeX

*Authors contributed equally

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Captured by Captions: On Memorization and its Mitigation in CLIP Models

Wenhao Wang, Adam Dziedzic, Grace C. Kim, Michael Backes, Franziska Boenisch

International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR). 2025.

PDF

BibTeX

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Interpretation Meets Safety: A Survey on Interpretation Methods and Tools for Improving LLM Safety

Seongmin Lee, Aeree Cho, Grace C. Kim, ShengYun Peng, Mansi Phute, Duen Horng (Polo) Chau

Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP Main). 2025.

PDF

BibTeX

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What's Your Stake in Sustainability of AI?: An Informed Insider's Guide

Grace C. Kim, Annabel Rothschild, Carl DiSalvo, Betsy DiSalvo

AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society (AIES). 2024.

PDF

BibTeX

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Transformer Explainer: Interactive Learning of Text-Generative Models

Aeree Cho*, Grace C. Kim*, Alexander Karpekov*, Alec Helbling, Zijie J. Wang, Seongmin Lee, Benjamin Hoover, Duen Horng (Polo) Chau

IEEE Visualization Conference (VIS Poster). 2024., AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI Demo). 2025.

Demo

PDF

Recording

Code

BibTeX

Best Poster

*Authors contributed equally

860,000+ users across 180+ countries, 6,000+ GitHub stars

#1 paper of the day on Hugging Face

Taught at top universities (e.g., MIT, Stanford, University of Toronto, ETH Zurich) and in Georgia Tech CSE 6242 Data and Visual Analytics (250-300 students per semester)

Grants and Funding

2025

Google Gift (\$75,000)
Co-PIs: Duen Horng (Polo) Chau
Co-first authored a proposal resulting in a \$75,000 unrestricted gift from Google

Conference Travels & Presentations

2025

IEEE Visualization Conference (VIS) 2025

2025

AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI) 2025
For "Transformer Explainer: Interactive Learning of Text-Generative Models"

2024

AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society (AIES) 2024
For "What's Your Stake in Sustainability of AI?: An Informed Insider's Guide"

2024

IEEE Visualization Conference (VIS) 2024
For "Transformer Explainer: Interactive Learning of Text-Generative Models"

Teaching

Spring 2023

Teaching Assistant
Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA
Object-Oriented Programming (CS 1331), Instructor: Richard Landry
Led weekly recitation classes for 50 students, held weekly office hours, and created and graded course materials for a course with 800 students enrolled.

Service

May 2025 — May 2026

Founding Member
Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA
Digital Equity & Empowerment Project
Design and lead workshops on AI safety and responsible use for Atlanta-based youths

Sep. 2022 — Apr. 2023

Web Developer & Administrator
Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA
Stamps Scholars National Convention
Managed website development and administration for a convention with 700 attendees from 40 schools

References

Dr. Mitchell Gordon, Professor
EECS/CSAIL
Massachusetts Institute of Technology
mitchellg.github.io/

Dr. Polo Chau, Professor
School of Computational Science and Engineering
Georgia Institute of Technology
cc.gatech.edu/~dchau/

Dr. Mark Riedl, Professor
School of Interactive Computing
Georgia Institute of Technology
eilab.gatech.edu/mark-riedl.html

Dr. Annabel Rothschild, Assistant Professor
Computer Science
Bard College
annabelrothschild.com/